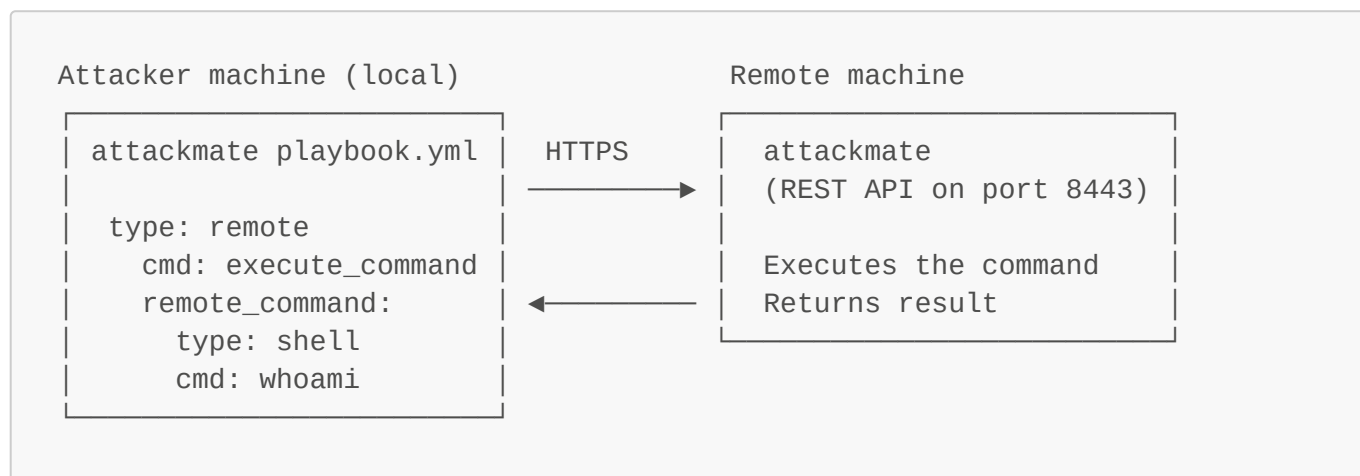


Remote Command Execution

AttackMate can orchestrate commands on other AttackMate instances running as API servers. The **remote** command type lets a local playbook trigger commands or entire sub-playbooks on a remote machine, useful for distributed attack scenarios, multi-host labs, or separating attacker infrastructure across network segments.

Architecture



Configuration

Remote instances are defined in the AttackMate config file under **remote_config**. Each entry specifies a URL, credentials, and a TLS certificate for verification:

```
# attackmate.yml
remote_config:
  pivot-node:
    url: https://192.168.1.50:8443
    username: admin
    password: secret
    cafile: /path/to/ca.pem
  dmz-sensor:
    url: https://10.0.0.254:8443
    username: sensor
    password: topsecret
    cafile: /path/to/ca.pem
```

When **connection** is omitted from a **remote** command, the first entry in **remote_config** is used as the default.

The **remote** Command

execute_command - Run a single command remotely

Sends one AttackMate command to the remote instance and waits for the result:

```
- type: remote
  cmd: execute_command
  connection: pivot-node
  remote_command:
    type: shell
    cmd: whoami
```

`remote_command` accepts any command type that the remote instance supports, `shell`, `ssh`, `msf-module`, `debug`, etc. The one exception is `type: remote` itself (no recursive remoting).

`execute_playbook` - Run a full playbook on a remote instance

Uploads a local playbook file and executes it on the remote instance:

```
- type: remote
  cmd: execute_playbook
  connection: pivot-node
  playbook_path: /home/user/playbooks/lateral_move.yml
```

This is useful for offloading a complex sequence of commands to a machine that has the right network access or tooling.

Important Behavior Notes

- Options like `background`, `only_if`, and `error_if` on the `remote` command itself control **local** execution, not the remote side.
- The remote instance must be running attackmate as a server and be reachable over HTTPS.
- The `cafile` must match the certificate used by the remote instance.

Example: Using Variables in Remote Commands

Variable substitution happens **locally** before the command is sent. So `$TARGET` in a `remote_command` is resolved on the local machine using the local variable store:

```
vars:
  TARGET: "10.10.10.5"

commands:
  - type: remote
    cmd: execute_command
    connection: pivot-node
    remote_command:
      type: shell
      cmd: ping -c 1 $TARGET # $TARGET is substituted locally to
"10.10.10.5"
```

Key Fields Reference

Field	Type	Required	Description
cmd	str	Yes	execute_command or execute_playbook
connection	str	No	Named connection from remote_config (default: first entry)
remote_command	command	When cmd: execute_command	Any AttackMate command except type: remote
playbook_path	str	When cmd: execute_playbook	Path to a local playbook file to upload and run